

John Escobedo

Senior QA Lead | AI Validation & LLM Output QA | Accessibility (508/WCAG) & User-Centered Testing

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Austin, Texas

Summary: Senior QA lead with 18+ years testing across healthcare, government, e-commerce, and emerging AI systems. I bring traditional QA rigor to AI products through LLM output validation, red-teaming, prompt engineering, and hallucination detection, holding model output to the same release standard as any other feature. Trilingual (English, Spanish, ASL), with accessibility expertise shaped by years working alongside the Deaf community.

SKILLS

Testing: Manual & Exploratory, Functional, Regression, UAT, Integration, Smoke & Sanity, End-to-End, Usability

Test Management: Test Strategy & Planning, Test Case Design, Requirements Traceability, Defect Triage & Root Cause Analysis, Release Go/No-Go & Risk Assessment, HIPAA Compliance

API & Platforms: REST & SOAP API Testing (Postman), .NET & Java Systems, Web Applications, Mobile (iOS/Android), Desktop (Windows/Mac/Linux), Cross-Browser & Cross-Platform Compatibility

AI & LLM Validation: LLM Output Validation, Hallucination Detection & Fact-Checking, Red Teaming & Adversarial Testing, Prompt Engineering & Pipeline Design, AI Workflow Automation, AI Pair Programming (Claude Code), AI Assistants (Claude, ChatGPT, Gemini, Local Models)

Business Analysis: Requirements Elicitation, User Stories & Acceptance Criteria, Gap Analysis, Process Mapping, Functional Specifications, Stakeholder Management, Change Management

Accessibility & Inclusion: Section 508 & WCAG, JAWS & NVDA Screen Readers, Inclusive User Research, End-User Advocacy, Deaf Cultural Competency & ASL (Conversational)

Leadership & Collaboration: Team Leadership & Mentoring, Scrum Master & Agile Transformation, SDLC, Process Standardization, Cross-Functional Collaboration, Remote & Distributed Teams

Tools & Technologies: JIRA (Admin) & Confluence, Xray & TestRail, GitHub & CI/CD Workflows, Chrome DevTools, SQL & JQL, JavaScript/HTML/CSS, Command Line

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Software Tester (Volunteer)

Sharpee.net | Austin, TX (Remote)

March 2026 to Present

Performed exploratory testing on a new web application, found silent-failure bugs that scripted tests missed, and contributed fixes and documentation directly to the codebase.

- Ran end-to-end exploratory testing across browsers and platforms, validating full user workflows.
- Caught silent-failure bugs that scripted tests missed, including cases where the app returned blank responses with no error signal.
- Built a custom failure-report template so any reader, technical or not, could immediately see what broke.

Robot Tele-Operator

Appttronik (via Insight Global) | Austin, TX

July 2025 to September 2025

Tested and documented humanoid robot behavior for Appttronik, writing procedures and bug reports engineering could act on directly.

- Cut physical test setup time by 75% by standardizing the preparation pattern, giving data collection consistent, repeatable conditions.
- Turned observed robot behaviors into clear bug reports engineering could act on immediately.
- Wrote startup, shutdown, and emergency shutdown procedures for 2 robot models where none existed, cutting new-tester ramp-up time by roughly 50% and becoming the team standard.

Senior QA Test Lead | Quality Assurance Tester | Scrum Master

GeekSI | Tallahassee, FL

March 2019 to June 2025

Led QA, UAT, and requirements analysis across multiple VA healthcare projects, drove Agile process adoption, and served as SME for complex clinical modules.

- Became the go-to SME for the Traumatic Brain Injury module, running knowledge transfer sessions so cross-functional teams could navigate the clinical requirements.
- Drove the Waterfall-to-Agile transition, introducing code freeze and release-candidate practices that shifted teams from reactive firefighting to predictable delivery.
- Managed test cases, defects, requirements documentation, and project dashboards in JIRA and Confluence across 6+ years and multiple VA projects.
- Ran SOAP API testing on VA home loan .NET applications and REST API testing via Postman on Java healthcare modules, validating service queries, data contracts, and data integrity.
- Built and executed test strategies for VA clinical healthcare applications across .NET and Java, covering UAT, regression, integration, smoke, sanity, end-to-end, and 508 compliance.
- Conducted user acceptance testing during two separate periods, organizing the testers, creating the tests, and gathering the results.
- Led 508 compliance initiatives and performed hands-on JAWS and NVDA screen-reader validation on VA clinical interfaces, catching accessibility issues visual inspection misses.
- Partnered with automation engineers to validate Cucumber and Selenium scripts, catching requirement-to-execution gaps before tests went into rotation.
- Built requirements traceability documentation mapping every business need to test coverage across web, mainframe, and mobile.

Senior QA Test Lead | Quality Assurance Tester

EverlyWell | Austin, TX

June 2018 to October 2018

Established QA processes and JIRA workflows from the ground up for a health tech startup's secure patient portal, partnering with engineering and product leadership on release validation.

- As JIRA administrator, designed a unified workflow with custom issue types, permission schemes, notifications, and dashboards, giving engineering and product real-time visibility into release status.
- Defined the initial QA process and release validation criteria for a team shipping without formal quality gates, bringing predictability to a fast-moving startup.
- Assessed release risk and delivered go/no-go recommendations to product and engineering leadership, balancing speed to market with quality.
- Validated releases across major browsers and mobile devices, catching requirement gaps before production.

QA Test Lead | QA Analyst

YouScience | Austin, TX

July 2017 to June 2018

As sole QA, built quality processes and test infrastructure from zero for the flagship education assessment platform, earning trust with development and product teams.

- Introduced foundational quality practices, including version control discipline, release candidates, and structured validation, to a team shipping without formal QA process, integrating quality as a respected part of the SDLC.

- Created end-to-end test and product documentation covering procedures, requirements traceability, verification standards, and feature release notes.
- Standardized user story and acceptance criteria templates, reducing ambiguity between developers and QA and speeding up delivery.
- Owned end-to-end validation for the flagship web application, gating every release across browsers and mobile platforms.

QA Tester | QA Analyst

Luna Data Solutions | Austin, TX

May 2015 to May 2017

QA Analyst contracted to RetailMeNot, coordinating cross-team testing for high-visibility e-commerce launches and aligning test priorities with business needs.

- Coordinated QA across multiple teams for the gift card feature launch supporting a \$22M acquisition, aligning test priorities with leadership expectations.
- Built custom JavaScript tools to validate site-wide analytics implementation and data integrity across the product.
- Triaged live production issues under pressure, communicating status updates to leadership during outages.
- Partnered with developers to improve internal tooling and CI/CD workflow, contributing changes that increased team efficiency.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Test Lead | QA Analyst, *Communication Services for the Deaf* (2013–2015)

Lead QA Tester | Quality Assurance Tester, *DocbookMD* (2012–2013)

QA Test Lead | QA Tester, *Luna Data Solutions* (2011–2012)

Game Master | Customer Experience & Trust Specialist, *Blizzard Entertainment* (2010–2011)

QA Analyst | Support Tools Developer | Community Operations, *Linden Lab* (2007–2010)

QA Tester, *Super Happy Fun Fun* (2006–2007)

QA Test Lead, QA Game Tester, *Aspyr Media* (2006–2006)

EDUCATION

Austin Community College - Austin, TX

Certificate in American Sign Language
2015 – 2017

ASL School - Austin, TX

Certificate in American Sign Language
2008 – 2012

Vista College - Berkeley, CA

Video Editing and Life Drawing
2001 – 2002

A.I. of Houston - Houston, TX

Fine Art, Typography, Layout, 3D Max
1995 – 1996

San Jacinto College - Pasadena, TX

Computer Science, Fine Art
1993 – 1995